



BENEFACTOR

THE TRANSCENDENT

Zone: The Horizon

Document B3

OD9 PROGRESSION SYSTEM



Workshop Overview

This workshop guides you through creating a concrete 5-year sustainability plan for a transformation initiative. Whether you're building a project within OD9, launching an external initiative, or planning your personal contribution to civilizational advancement—this framework applies.

By the end, you'll have a documented, actionable plan that addresses:

- Resource generation sustainability
 - Leadership succession
 - Institutional resilience
 - Impact measurement
 - Adaptive capacity
-

Prerequisites

Before beginning, you should have:

- Completed the "Institutional Immortality" reading
 - Completed the "Legacy Systems" reading
 - Familiarity with Chapter 66 (Resource Generation Framework)
 - A specific initiative/project in mind (or willingness to plan for OD9 itself)
-

Part 1: Initiative Definition (30 minutes)

Exercise 1.1: The Core Purpose Statement

Write a single sentence that captures why your initiative exists. This should:

- Be purpose-focused, not activity-focused
- Work regardless of specific methods
- Resonate 50 years from now as much as today

Format:

```
[Initiative Name] exists to [core purpose] for [who it serves].
```

Examples:

- "The ASCEND Research Cell exists to generate actionable knowledge for civilization-scale coordination for communities building Type 1 capabilities."
- "Fresh Tha Platform exists to provide infrastructure for independent artists and creators to build sustainable careers for musicians and creators underserved by traditional industry."

Your turn: Write your core purpose statement below.

[Your statement here]

Exercise 1.2: The Sacred/Adaptable Distinction

List what's SACRED (won't change) vs. ADAPTABLE (expected to change):

Sacred (Hold forever)	Adaptable (Expect evolution)	----- -----	
Example: Evidence-based approach	Example: Specific technologies used		Example:
Consciousness evolution focus	Example: Community platforms		[Your sacred #1] [Your
adaptable #1]	[Your sacred #2] [Your adaptable #2]		[Your sacred #3] [Your adaptable #3]
[Your sacred #4]	[Your adaptable #4]		

Exercise 1.3: Current State Assessment

Rate your initiative (1-10) on each dimension:

Dimension	Score (1-10)	Evidence/Reasoning	----- ----- -----	Resource
sustainability		Leadership depth		Documentation quality
clarity		Adaptive capacity		Community health
				Impact

Average score: ____

Biggest gap: ____

Part 2: Resource Sustainability Plan (45 minutes)

Exercise 2.1: Current Resource Flows

Map your current resource situation:

Inflows:	Source	Monthly Value	% of Total	Dependency Risk
-----	-----	-----	-----	Example: Grants \$2,000 40% High (ends in 6 months)

|| [Source 1] || || || [Source 2] || || || [Source 3] || || ||

Outflows: | Category | Monthly Cost | Essential? | Reducible? |

|-----|-----|-----|-----| | Example: Hosting | \$100 | Yes | Partially | | [Expense 1] || || ||
[Expense 2] || || || [Expense 3] || || ||

Current burn rate: \$____/month **Current runway:** ____ months

Exercise 2.2: The Regenerative Test

Answer each question:

1. Does your initiative create more value than it consumes?

- ☐ Yes, clearly - ☐ Somewhat - ☐ No - ☐ Don't know

Evidence: ____

2. Could it sustain itself indefinitely without external grants/donations?

- ☐ Yes, now - ☐ Within 1 year - ☐ Within 3 years - ☐ Within 5 years - ☐ Never

What would need to change: ____

3. Are resource generation methods aligned with your values?

- ☐ Perfectly aligned - ☐ Mostly aligned - ☐ Some tension - ☐ Significant compromise

Tensions to resolve: ____

Exercise 2.3: 5-Year Resource Model

Design your target state at Year 5:

Diversified Income Streams: | Stream | Year 1 | Year 3 | Year 5 | Notes |

|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----| | Stream 1 | \$____ | \$____ | \$____ | | | Stream 2 | \$____ | \$____ |
\$____ | | | Stream 3 | \$____ | \$____ | \$____ | | | Stream 4 | \$____ | \$____ | \$____ | | | **Total** | \$____ |
\$____ | \$____ | |

Target metrics at Year 5:

- Monthly revenue: \$____
- Months of reserves: ____
- % from largest source: ____ (target <40%)

- % self-generated vs. donated: ____

Part 3: Leadership & Succession (45 minutes)

Exercise 3.1: Critical Functions Inventory

List every function critical to your initiative's operation:

Function	Current Person	Backup?	Documentation?	Bus Factor
Example: Strategy decisions	Founder	No	Partial	1
[Function 1]				
[Function 2]				
[Function 3]				
[Function 4]				
[Function 5]				

Bus Factor = How many people could be "hit by a bus" before this function fails?

- 1 = Critical risk
- 2 = Some risk
- 3+ = Healthy

Exercise 3.2: Succession Pipeline

For each critical function, design the development path:

Function: _____

Stage	Skills Required	Training Method	Timeline
Apprentice			
Practitioner			
Expert			
Teacher			

Who is currently at each stage?

- Apprentice: ____
- Practitioner: ____
- Expert: ____
- Teacher: ____

Repeat for each critical function.

Exercise 3.3: The "I'm Gone" Test

Imagine you (or your key leader) disappears tomorrow—permanently.

Within 1 week, what breaks?

- ____
- ____
- ____

Within 1 month, what fails?

- ____
- ____
- ____

Within 1 year, what dies?

- ____
- ____
- ____

What must be true for the initiative to survive this scenario?

- ____
- ____
- ____

Action items to close the gaps:

1. ____
2. ____
3. ____

Part 4: Resilience Architecture (30 minutes)

Exercise 4.1: Failure Mode Analysis

For each failure mode, assess your vulnerability:

Failure Mode	Current Risk (1-10)	Mitigation in Place?	Additional Mitigation Needed	
-----	-----	-----	-----	Founder Dependency
Calcification	Mission Drift	Ecological Shift	Internal Conflict	

Exercise 4.2: Redundancy Design

For each critical asset, identify backup strategies:

Asset	Primary	Backup 1	Backup 2	Notes
Knowledge base				
Communication platform				
Financial resources				
Community relationships				
Decision-making authority				

Exercise 4.3: Stress Test Scenarios

How would your initiative respond to each scenario?

Scenario 1: Key platform disappears Your main platform (Discord/website/etc.) shuts down tomorrow.

- Impact: ____
- Recovery time: ____
- Mitigation: ____

Scenario 2: Funding crisis All external funding stops for 6 months.

- Impact: ____
- Recovery time: ____
- Mitigation: ____

Scenario 3: Public controversy A prominent member does something that generates negative attention.

- Impact: ____
- Recovery time: ____
- Mitigation: ____

Scenario 4: Rapid growth You 10x your membership in 3 months.

- Impact: ____
- Recovery time: ____
- Mitigation: ____

Part 5: Impact & Measurement (30 minutes)

Exercise 5.1: Theory of Change

Complete the logic chain:

```
If we [activities you do]...
Then [immediate outputs]...
Which leads to [short-term outcomes]...
Which contributes to [medium-term outcomes]...
Which moves toward [long-term civilizational impact].
```

Your theory of change:

```
If we _____
Then _____
Which leads to _____
Which contributes to _____
Which moves toward _____
```

Exercise 5.2: Measurable Indicators

For each outcome level, define measurable indicators:

Level	Indicator	Current Baseline	Year 3 Target	Year 5 Target	
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	Output Short-term Medium-term
	Long-term proxy				

Exercise 5.3: Learning Loops

How will you know if you're working?

Feedback mechanisms:	Source	Frequency	How it changes your approach
-----	-----	-----	

Scheduled reviews:

- Weekly: ____
- Monthly: ____
- Quarterly: ____
- Annually: ____

Part 6: Integration & Commitment (15 minutes)

Exercise 6.1: The 5-Year Vision Statement

Based on all your work, write a paragraph describing your initiative at Year 5:

By [Year 5 date], [Initiative Name] will have achieved _____.

We will be sustainably resourced through _____, with a leadership pipeline that includes _____.

Our core purpose of _____ will be advancing through _____, measured by _____.

The initiative will be resilient to _____ and adaptive to _____.

We will have contributed to civilizational advancement by _____.

Exercise 6.2: Quarterly Milestones

Break down Year 1 into quarterly milestones:

Quarter	Resource Goal	Succession Goal	Resilience Goal	Impact Goal
Q1				
Q2				
Q3				
Q4				

Exercise 6.3: Accountability

Who will you share this plan with?

- _____

When will you review/update it?

- _____

What's your first action within 48 hours?

- _____

Workshop Completion

You've completed the 5-Year Sustainability Model Workshop when you have:

- ☐ Core purpose statement (Exercise 1.1)
- ☐ Sacred/adaptable distinction (Exercise 1.2)

- ☐ Current state assessment (Exercise 1.3)
- ☐ 5-year resource model (Exercise 2.3)
- ☐ Succession pipeline for each critical function (Exercise 3.2)
- ☐ "I'm Gone" test action items (Exercise 3.3)
- ☐ Failure mode mitigation plan (Exercise 4.1)
- ☐ Theory of change (Exercise 5.1)
- ☐ Measurable indicators (Exercise 5.2)
- ☐ 5-year vision statement (Exercise 6.1)
- ☐ Q1-Q4 milestones for Year 1 (Exercise 6.2)

Submit your completed workshop via /engage with content type "exercise" for credit.

Post-Workshop: Living Document Protocol

This plan should be:

- **Reviewed quarterly:** Is it still accurate? What's changed?
- **Updated annually:** Full refresh based on new learning
- **Shared with stakeholders:** Transparency builds accountability
- **Tested against reality:** When reality diverges, either update the plan or change course

The plan is a tool, not a monument. Use it. Adapt it. Let it serve the purpose.

"A plan that survives contact with reality isn't a rigid document—it's a living framework for principled adaptation."